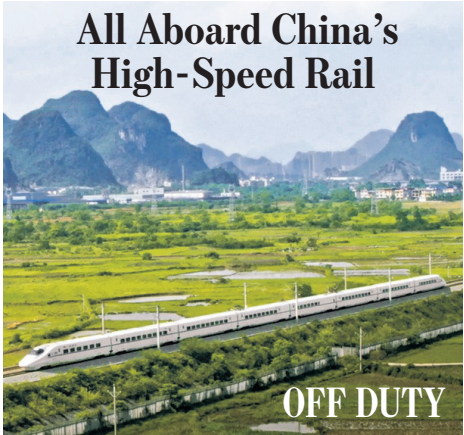




WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND



DOW JONES | News Corp ***** SATURDAY/SUNDAY, AUGUST 2 - 3, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVI NO. 28 WSJ.com ★★★★★ \$6.00

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **U.S. hiring slowed** sharply over the summer, with jobs figures for May and June revised downward and July's number falling short of economists' expectations. **A1**
- ◆ **Trump fired the top** Bureau of Labor Statistics official after the government published the data showing that U.S. hiring slowed. **A2**
- ◆ **The weak jobs data** and Trump's revamped tariff plan sent U.S. stocks sharply lower, with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow shedding 1.6%, 2.2% and 1.2%, respectively. **B11**
- ◆ **Exxon Mobil** and Chevron reported steep declines in second-quarter earnings, driven by lower oil prices, as big foreign producers brought on more barrels. **B9**
- ◆ **Nintendo's first-quarter** net profit jumped 19%, helped by robust sales of the company's new Switch 2 console. **B9**
- ◆ **Shares of Universal Music** fell after second-quarter earnings and free cash flow missed expectations. **B10**
- ◆ **Online marketplace Etsy** is changing its marketing strategy to answer a decline in buyers as consumers grow more cautious. **B10**
- ◆ **Kimberly-Clark's** second-quarter adjusted profit came in above Wall Street estimates but sales fell short of analysts' expectations. **B10**

World-Wide

- ◆ **The death toll** from Russia's aerial bombardment of Ukraine's capital Thursday rose to 31, making the strikes among the worst of the 3½-year war, with four more children among the victims. **A9**
- ◆ **Trump said he would** position two nuclear submarines "in the appropriate regions" in response to comments from former Russian President Dmitry Medvedev, escalating tensions as the U.S. pressures Russia to end the Ukraine war. **A9**
- ◆ **Former Epstein associate** Ghislaine Maxwell was transferred from a federal prison in Florida to a lower-security facility in Texas to serve her 20-year sentence. **A6**
- ◆ **A Florida jury found** Tesla was partly to blame for a fatal 2019 collision involving a vehicle equipped with the company's driver-assistance software, awarding the plaintiffs nearly \$329 million in damages. **A6**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** blocked funding for a swath of public-health programs run by the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. **A4**
- ◆ **The Corporation for Public Broadcasting** said it would start to wind down its operations after the elimination of its federal funding last month. **A3**
- ◆ **Trump is amassing** an enormous war chest, using his office to keep bringing in donors and looking ahead to next year's midterm elections. **A4**

NOONAN
Stop the ICE workplace raids **A13**

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Hiring Slows Sharply in Summer

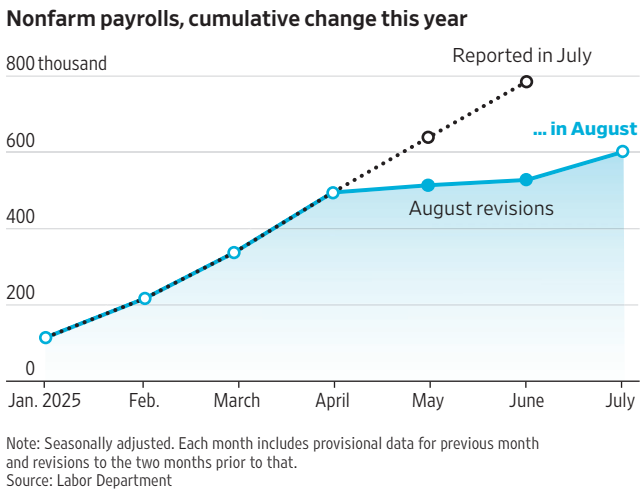
Stocks and yields fall after data revisions suggest a weaker jobs market

By RACHEL WOLFE AND JUSTIN LAHART

After months of uncertainty, July's job's report is clear: The U.S. economy is beginning to show signs of slowing. The U.S. added a seasonally adjusted 73,000 jobs in July, the Labor Department reported Friday, below the 100,000 that economists polled by The Wall

Street Journal had expected. Revisions cut down the jobs growth originally reported for May and June by a combined 258,000. That left May as having added just 19,000 jobs and June just 14,000. A storm of changes is keeping business leaders cautious. Tariffs are weighing on manufacturing. Workplace raids are hurting immigrant-dependent sectors like landscaping and meatpacking. And cutbacks to the federal workforce are squeezing government hiring. "To see three months in a row of fewer than half of industries adding jobs is unprec-

edented outside of a recession," said Wells Fargo senior economist Sarah House. "Businesses are standing pat with their head counts as they wait to see what lies ahead." President Trump on Friday afternoon said he had directed his team to fire the top official at the Bureau of Labor Statistics after the release of the soft data. That move raised concerns among economists and former officials that it could open the door for American Please turn to page A2



◆ **Trump ousts statistician** over soft data..... **A2**

Palestinians Swarm Aid Trucks Entering Gaza



CHAOS: Palestinians climb on vehicles carrying relief supplies Friday in the northern Gaza Strip. A breakdown of law and order, with mobs ransacking aid trucks, is preventing food from reaching the most vulnerable people, aid workers say. **A8**

September Rate-Cut Path Gets Clearer

By NICK TIMIRAOUS

The July jobs report could give Federal Reserve officials a sense of déjà vu. Last year, officials decided against cutting interest rates at their July policy meeting, but an employment report two days later suggested the labor market wasn't as strong as it looked. Officials made up for it by cutting rates by a half-percentage point, larger than the traditional quarter point increment, at their subsequent meeting in September. This past week, officials also held rates steady, only to wake up Friday to news that the labor market unexpectedly cooled during the past few months. Traders increased the chances of a September rate cut to more than 70% from 38% Thursday. The situations aren't exactly the same, of course. Last year, inflation was heading lower. This year, officials are worried Please turn to page A2

‘Combat Cocktail’: How We Overmedicate Vets

To treat PTSD, the VA put hundreds of thousands of patients on multiple streams of medications—despite suicide risk

By SHALINI RAMACHANDRAN AND BETSY MCKAY

After cycling through a dizzying array of psychiatric medications, Scott Griffin found himself with the barrel of a gun in his mouth in November. Diagnosed with post-traumatic stress disorder, Griffin had served as a paratrooper with special operations forces, witnessing intense combat in Afghanistan, Syria and Iraq. Army doctors put him on a version of what veterans call the “combat cocktail”: a mix of powerful drugs taken simultaneously.

Griffin's medical records reveal a long list prescribed over a decade, including medicines for nightmares, migraines, anxiety, depression and side effects including gastrointestinal distress and erectile dysfunction. At times, he says he was on at least three and as many as nine central nervous system drugs at once. The Department of Veterans Affairs continued several of the prescriptions after he was discharged in 2022. He experienced waking nightmares and brain fog. Doctors never told him about risks from the drugs, he said. Please turn to page A10

Software IPO Left \$3 Billion on Table

By CORRIE DRIEBUSCH AND HANNAH ERIN LANG

Shares in software maker Figma posted eye-popping gains in their stock-market debut Thursday. Also eye-popping: the \$3 billion the company left on the table by underpricing its shares. Figma and selling shareholders raised \$1.2 billion in the IPO. They could have pocketed much more had the initial shares, priced at \$33 apiece, been priced higher. Bankers often say pricing an IPO is an art, not a science. Companies and selling share-

holders want to raise as much money as they can in their IPOs. But they also want the morale boost that comes with a rise on the first day of trading. The ideal first-day gains are typically around 20% to 30%, many bankers who work on deals say. If gains exceed that amount by too much, whispers abound that bankers left money on the table. Ahead of Figma's offering, IPOs this year rose an average 13% on their first day of trading, according to Dealogic. Figma's jumped 250%. Several factors likely played Please turn to page A6

Latest Weapons Against Wolves? AC/DC and Scarlett Johansson

To protect livestock from the predators, U.S. uses drones that blast alarming sounds

By JIM CARLTON AND ANGELA OWENS

MACDOEL, Calif.—The forensics team piled out of pickup trucks and fanned into the woods to hunt for clues behind a cold-blooded killing. “It is like a wildlife CSI we are doing,” said Dustin Rangelack, a USDA predator researcher, kneeling to inspect fresh paw prints that led to a pasture where hundreds of cows were nervously grazing. A calf had been devoured

by a wolf a night earlier and now the team planned to try and find the culprit—using a drone to scare it away with AC/DC’s “Thunderstruck” among other sounds. Once endangered gray wolves are terrorizing livestock herds across the American West, like the one on the Prather Ranch here near the Oregon border where owners Jim and Mary Rickert figure they have lost as many as 40 calves to the voracious carn-

EXCHANGE



COUNTERPUNCH
The leaner, meaner Chevron is ready to fight for its future. **B1**

Superrich Buy Rolexes, \$650 T-Shirts in Bulk

By SARAH SPELLINGS

Every year, Lee Evans Lee buys herself a new long teddy coat from the Italian fashion brand Max Mara, a classic design that currently starts at \$4,460. She keeps a few of them in each of her homes: her primary house in San Antonio, her vacation home in Aspen and her ranch in Texas. This means she doesn't have to worry about taking them with her when she travels. “If I'm carrying three teddy coats on an airplane, that would take up one gigantic duffel bag,” she said.

For luxury shoppers willing to spend big, it is possible to have it all. Many buy multiples of the pieces they love, from Loro Piana capes and Celine jeans to Rolex watches, so that every one of their homes has a reliable wardrobe of high-end essentials. “I always want to look glamorous, I never compromise style in a look for convenience,” said Lee, the founder of the fashion company Mrs. Momma Bear and a recreational polo player. Her basics go beyond white tees and jeans: She keeps Christian Please turn to page A6